

Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com

Snail Mail: The Editor, Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar Building, MIDC, TTC Industrial Estate, Nerul Navi Mumbai 400 706

Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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manipulation software, while Linux has many image manipulation as well as graphics software—FREE.

7. To play audio CDs or MP3s or DVDs in Windows, you need Windows Media Player, Winamp, Power DVD, or WinDVD, while Linux has already installed many software for this purpose.

8. To burn a CD / DVD in Windows, you need Nero, while Linux has three to four CD / DVD burning software already.

9. The Evolution software that Linux provides is 70 per cent superior to Outlook Express.

10. Windows need not only a high-end computer for audio / video editing, but also costly software for it. Whereas, on a Pentium III using Linux, it's all possible for FREE!!!

11. To hack a password on Windows is quite easy, while data decryption and hacking passwords in Linux is almost impossible.

12. Apart from buying Windows, the user needs a useless software called MS Office, also, that is high-priced. Star Office and Open Office.org provide much more benefits to customers, under GNU!

13. For chatting, we need separate messengers for MSN or Yahoo, while Gaim in Linux gives facility to chat simultaneously in Yahoo MSN, and all other chat service providers.

I am amazed that when such features can be given under GNU, why does Microsoft charge so much money for the same features? I would like you to print this to open the eyes of customers and save them from being cheated.

Rishi Kalra

Dear Rishi,

I must tell you that most of your points are misinformed, which I shall address one by one.

- #3 is not really true: most Linux distros today need a decent setup.

- As for #4, if you have non-standard hardware, good luck finding Linux drivers for them! Driver support is one of the things that has plagued Linux for many years now.

- #6: You have MS Paint in Windows, which is useful enough for many purposes. Plus, there are open source software or freeware that you can install on Windows!

- Regarding #7, we must remind you that WMP and Winamp are also free.

- #8: You have drag-n-drop burning in Windows XP.

- In #9, you've quoted a "70 per cent" figure, which is unsubstantiated.

- In #10, you've said that audio and video

editing using Linux is possible for free. We must ask you what software you're using. Besides, VirtualDub for Windows is free.

- We should tell you that you're completely wrong in #11 when you say that Windows passwords can easily be cracked.

- You can use Star Office and OpenOffice, which you've mentioned in #12, on Windows too.

- As for #13, just use Gaim on Windows! Finally, Windows stands out because of better support and easy usability, amongst other things. I do not deny that Linux does hold certain advantages, but you cannot rule out Windows' convenience totally—not as yet.

— Executive Editor

Thanks For Everything

Hello ji! Ji main taan Digit da deewana haan! I have been reading your magazine from my 7th class. Now I am in 2nd year of my computer engineering diploma course. Till 11th, sometimes, I borrowed issues from friends, and after 11th, my friends now borrow from me. Your magazine is kool, awesome, wonderful, great, unmatched!

But I want to ask you to please include some full, old, less-hardware-requiring games like *Metal Gear*, James Bond's older versions, etc. Please also include some tutorials, notes, etc. on C, C++, Java, and some interesting secrets of Windows that people don't normally know about.

And finally, lots of warm wishes from me to all members of your team, especially Agent001. I like him. I think he is the wisest computer user in the world—he knows what to upgrade when, how, with what, and at what cost. So keep it up, *doston!*

Davinder Sharda

Punjab

Dear Davinder,

Ji aapka shukriya. Thanks for your passionate mail—it's such mails that keep us on our toes, twenty-five hours a day, 32 days a month! We're really glad you've been enjoying whatever we've been publishing.

As for games that require lower hardware configurations, you can find many of them on our CD/DVD—you just haven't browsed through them carefully enough! And when it comes to programming tutorials etc., we're mulling over the idea of *Fast Track* editions on these.

Once again, thanks for writing in!

— Executive Editor

"Customer Service"!

This is about "pirated" software: I prefer to call them non-genuine software instead of "pirated." I haven't seen any ads in *Digit* for software because they—the software sellers—know it's a waste of money: nobody purchases genuine software. Mostly, if I ask for genuine software, I have to pay more, and get the same thing in better packing.

Shop-wallahs say they have to check whether the CD is working properly or not and to avoid complaints from customers, and that's why they open the packaging. Talk about Customer Service!

Coming to the point, will you please publish the names of a few shops in Mumbai who can be trusted and sell genuine software? I also request our dear Agent 001 to take some trouble for the sake of subscribers who want genuine software.

Another thing: I was under the impression that I had a genuine OS installed on my computer, as I had insisted on it and paid when I purchased it two years ago. However, while installing IE7, I found that it is not genuine! I could not argue with the dealer after two years—will the *Digit* team help me?

P V Vithlani

Rajkot

Dear Mr Vithlani,

We know that piracy is rampant in India as in much of the developing world, and all we can do is hope that the situation will improve in the years to come. Who has the energy to fight all the software pirates out there?

It is up to the software companies to combat piracy. We, as a magazine, can do nothing but make our readers aware of the situation.

As for genuine software, you're sure to find some shops at Lamington Road in Mumbai if you look around—we've seen some even here in Navi Mumbai. Also, look in newspaper classifieds. In addition, there have indeed been ads in our magazine by suppliers of genuine software.

We're happy that more and more readers like you are bothered by the piracy problem, putting an end to the "*chalta ha*" attitude.

— Executive Editor

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH